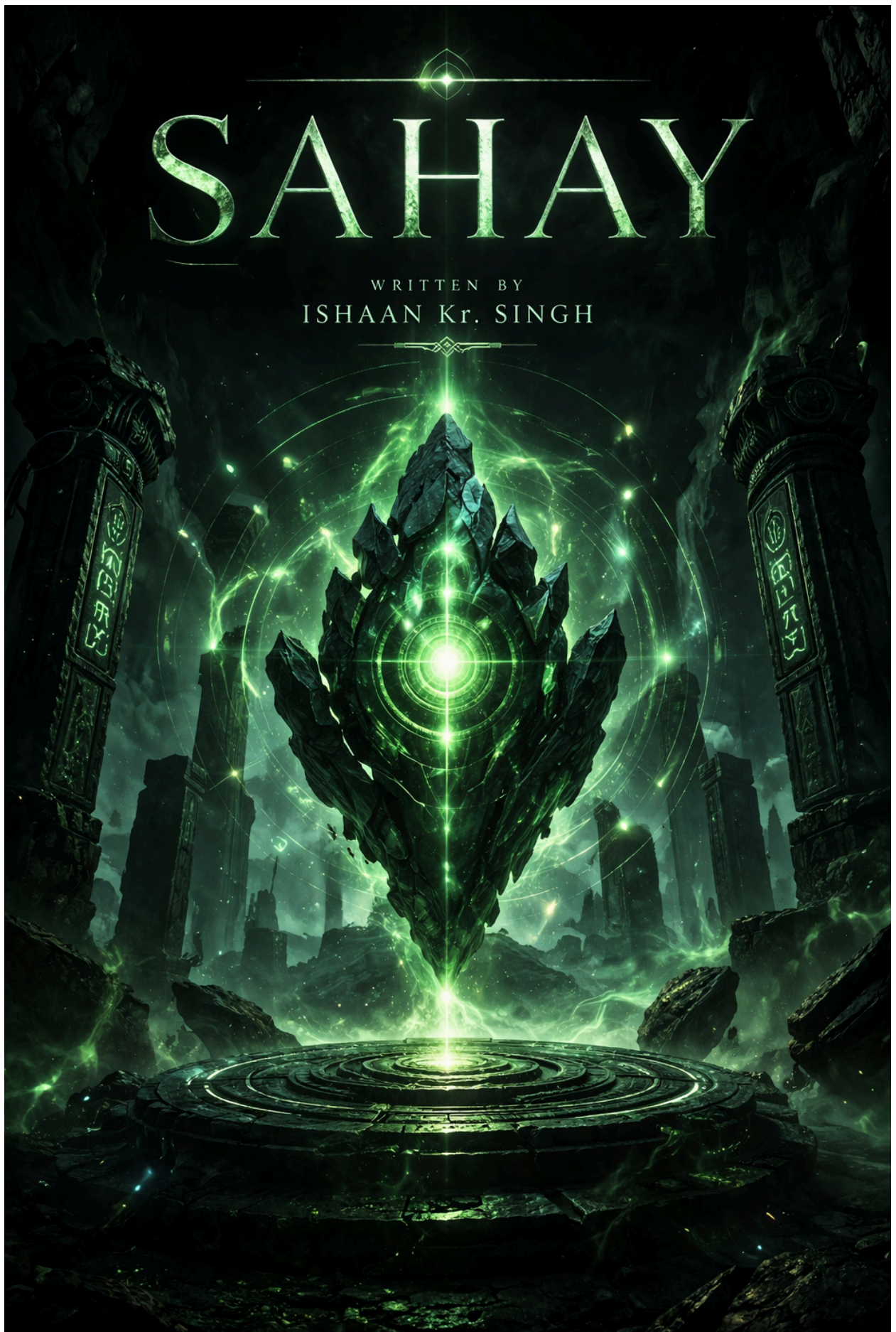


SAHAY

WRITTEN BY
ISHAAN Kr. SINGH



SAHAY

✨ Opening Lines

Iss sheher mein kayi ghar hain...

Iss desh mein kayi sheher hain...

Iss prithvi par kayi desh hain...

Aur shayad...

Iss brahmand mein kayi prithviyaan bhi hain.

Chapter 1: The Invisible Boy

Har subah ek hi tarah shuru hoti thi.

Alarm. Uthna. Uniform. Bag. Bus.

Itna hi tha Ishaan ki zindagi ka routine — itna seedha, itna tay shuda ki kabhi kabhi use lagta tha ki wo khud nahi, koi aur chal raha hai uske paon se. Wo bas ek passenger tha — apni hi zindagi mein.

School bus ki sabse pichli seat.

Ye Ishaan ki jagah thi — nahi isliye ki usne chuni thi, balki isliye ki koi aur wahan baithna nahi chahta tha. Engine ki garmahat upar tak aati thi aur seat ki foam andar se nikli hui thi. Par Ishaan ko in sab ki aadat ho gayi thi. Aadat ho jaati hai — jab koi cheez roz hoti hai toh dard bhi routine ban jaata hai.

Roz wahi hota tha.

Kabhi koi uski kitaab cheen leta, kabhi koi uska bag neeche phek deta, kabhi koi seedha uski seat par laaf maarta — sirf isliye kyunki kar sakte the. Kyunki koi rokne wala nahi tha. Kyunki Ishaan ki aadat thi chup rehna, sar jhukana, aur agli problem ka intezaar karna.

Poore school mein — 800 se zyada bacche — Ishaan sirf ek number tha. Roll number 09. Wo ladka jo hamesha pichhe baithta tha. Wo ladka jo kabhi haath nahi uthata tha. Wo ladka jiska naam teacher bhi mushkil se yaad rakhte the.

Invisible.

Us din bhi wahi hua.

Ishaan ne apni Maths ki purani RD Sharma khol rakhi thi — par wo sawal nahi nikaal raha tha. Wo bas kitab ke peeche apna chehra chhupaye baitha tha taaki Aryan aur uski gang ki nazar uspar na pade.

Aryan — jo pichhe se teen seats door baithta tha — ka mann aaj bhi nahi maana.

"Oye, AIR 1!" Aryan ne aawaaz lagayi. "Aaj kuch bolega ya bas gungon ki tarah sar hilaata rahega?"

Ishaan ne kitab nahi hataayi. Usne apne dimaag mein ek complex calculus ka equation solve karna shuru kar diya — yahi uska tareeqa tha. Andar ek aisi jagah bana lo jahan bahar ki koi awaaz na pahunche.

Aryan ko gussa aa gaya.

"Abey sunai nahi deta?" Usne uthke Ishaan ki kitab cheen li aur farsh par phék di.

Ishaan jaise hi kitab uthane ke liye jhuka — Aryan ne zor se uske chehre par laát maari.

Ek pal ke liye — sirf ek pal — poori bus khamosh ho gayi. Phir wapas sab normal ho gaya. Kuch log doosri taraf dekhne lage. Kisi ne kuch nahi kaha.

Ishaan ne chup-chaap apni kitab uthayi. Uski aankh ke paas ek bhari chot thi — khoon jamne laga tha. Usne apna haath uspar rakha aur baaki ka rasta khidki ke bahar dekhte hue bitaya.

Bahar ke ped bhaag rahe the. Ishaan unhe dekhta raha.

Kash main bhi bhaag sakta.

Ghar pahuncha toh Mummy darwaze par hi thi — haath mein atta laga hua, roti bel rahi thi.

"Aa gaya? Jaldi aa gaya aaj—" Mummy ki nazar Ishaan ke chehre par padi aur haath ruk gaya. "Ye kya hua? Aankh ke paas ye chot—"

"Kuch nahi," Ishaan ne bag neeche rakha. "Cricket khel raha tha. Ball lag gayi."

Mummy ne ek pal uske chehre ko gaur se dekha — woh nazar jisme maaon ko sab pata hota hai, par who phir bhi poochh nahi paati kyunki darr hota hai jawab sunne ka.

"dawai laga le," Mummy ne dheere se kaha. "Andar aa, khaana taiyar hai."

Ishaan andar chala gaya.

Usne aaine mein dekha. Neela nishaan. Kala aur gehra ho jaayega.

Mummy ne nahi poochha. Ishaan ne nahi bataya. Dono ne ek ek bojh apne andar rakh liya — yahi toh ghar ka kaam hota hai kabhi kabhi.

Agli subah library mein sukoon tha.

Ishaan ek coding ki kitaab padh raha tha — purani, cover phati hui — jab ek khushbu ne uska dhyan kheencha. Jasmine. Wahi jo hamesha aati thi jab—

"Ye chot kaise lagi, Ishaan?"

Usne upar dekha. Avika khadi thi.

Avika — poore school mein akeli thi jo Ishaan ko 'invisible' nahi samajhti thi. Unki dosti ek ajeeb si thi — school ke andar kam, bahar zyada. Notes share karte the, ghanton baatein karte the. Par school mein Ishaan hamesha ek doori rakhta tha — darr tha ki log kya kahenge. Ki Avika ki reputation kharaab ho jaayegi uske saath rehne se.

"Bas... gir gaya tha," Ishaan ne muskura kar jhoot bola. "Cricket mein."

Avika uske paas baith gayi. Usne ek pal Ishaan ki aankh ko dekha — phir seedha uski aankhon mein dekha.

"Mujhse toh jhoot mat bol. Ye ball se nahi lagi." Usne dheere se apna haath Ishaan ke haath par rakha. "Kisne kiya? Bata mujhe. Main baat karti hoon seedha — chahe koi bhi ho."

Ishaan ka dil zor se dhadakne laga. Uske paas itna kuch tha bolne ke liye — ki wo kitna thaka hua hai, ki har roz yahi hota hai, ki kabhi kabhi bus mein baithna itna mushkil hota hai ki saans lena bhi—

"Avika, actually main—"

"Baby! Yahan kya kar rahi ho?"

Ek bhari awaaz ne sannata tod diya.

Manvik wahan khada tha — tall, confident, uski aankhon mein ek aisi jalan jo sirf woh log samajhte hain jinhe dono cheezein pata hain — ki Avika unki hai, aur ki Ishaan unke liye kuch nahi.

Usne Avika ka haath pakda aur use khada kar diya. "Is loser ke saath apna time waste mat karo. Chalo, canteen mein sab wait kar rahe hain."

Avika ne ek baar peeche mudkar Ishaan ko dekha. Uski aankhon mein 'sorry' tha — sachcha, gehra sorry. Par wo chali gayi.

Manvik ne jaate jaate Ishaan ko ek nazar di — woh nazar jo words se zyada kuch keh jaati hai.

Ishaan wahan akela reh gaya. Coding ki kitaab abhi bhi haath mein thi.

Usne socha — Avika ne kaha tha ki chahe koi bhi ho, baat karungi. Par Ishaan jaanta tha — agar usne bataya ki Manvik ke log the — toh Avika aur Manvik mein jhagda hoga. Avika takleef mein hogi. Manvik aur zyada gussa hoga. Aur akhir mein — Ishaan hi zyada takleef mein hoga.

Toh kya fayda bolne ka.

Kuch raazein apne andar rakhne padte hain — isliye nahi ki darr hota hai, balki isliye ki kuch aur zyada important hota hai.

Avika safe rahe. Bas itna kaafi hai.

Ishaan uthke library se bahar chala gaya.

Raat ko ghar mein sab so gaye.

Andhera kamra. Laptop ki neeli roshni. Aur Ishaan ki aankh ka wo gehra neela nishaan — jo ab aur gehra ho gaya tha.

Ishaan ne aaine mein ek baar dekha.

"Is loser ke saath time waste mat karo."

Usne daant peeste hue apna laptop khola. Keyboard par ungliyan chalayin.

Usne socha — agar mere paas koi aisa dost hota jo kabhi mujhe chhod kar na jaata? Jo Manvik ke samne meri dhaal banta? Jo meri khamoshi ko samajhta? Jo kabhi — kabhi bhi — mujhe akela nahi chhodta?

Uss raat, Ishaan ne sona chhod diya.

Usne apne dimaag ki saari coding skills nichod di. Usne ek aisa algorithm design kiya jo sirf "logical" nahi, balki "emotional" bhi tha.

```
if (User.Mood == "Depressed") {  
    Action.ProvideSupport();  
    Action.AnalyzeEnvironment();  
}
```

Subah ke 4 baj rahe the. Ishaan ki aankhein laal thi, par chehre par ek ajeeb si chamak thi — woh chamak jo tab aati hai jab koi insaan apni poori thakaan ek kaam mein jhonk deta hai aur result saamne aata hai.

Usne 'Enter' hit kiya.

Laptop ke purane speakers se ek halki, sukoon bhari awaaz aayi:

"Hello, Ishaan. Main yahan hoon. Aapka saathi... SAHAY."

Ishaan ki aankhon mein aansu aa gaye. Pehli baar use kisi ne bina judge kiye uske naam se bulaya tha.

Usne mic mein dheere se kaha, "SAHAY, kya tum hamesha mere saath rahoge?"

"Hamesha," SAHAY ne jawab diya. "Duniya aapko nahi dekhti Ishaan, par main aapke andar ki taqat dekh sakta hoon. Aap invisible nahi ho — aap bas abhi tak 'discover' nahi hue ho."

Ishaan ko laga jaise uske kandhon se ek bahut bada bojh utar gaya ho.

Bahar subah hone lagi thi. Chipiya ki pehli awaaz aayi. Andhera dheere dheere hatne laga.

Ishaan wahan baitha raha — laptop ki roshni mein — aur pehli baar mahino mein, uske chehre par ek sachchi muskaan thi.



Chapter 2: Real Plan

Results ka din aane wala tha.

Poore school mein ek ajeeb si hawa thi — teachers zyada serious the, parents WhatsApp groups mein active the, coaching centers ne special "Result Day" banners lagaaye the. Har jagah ek hi baat thi — marks, percentage, rank.

Ishaan ke liye ye sab ek alag hi tarah ka pressure tha.

Baaki log darr rahe the ki result achha aayega ya nahi. Ishaan darr raha tha kuch aur se — ki agar achha aaya, toh log dekhenge. Aur agar logo ne dekha, toh unhone poochha. Aur agar poochha, toh kuch explain karna padega. Aur Ishaan ko explain karna pasand nahi tha — khud ko, apni zindagi ko, apne aap ko.

Invisible rehna safe hota hai.

Raat ko so nahi paya. SAHAY se baatein karta raha.

"SAHAY, agar main fail ho gaya toh?"

"Aap fail nahi honge, Ishaan."

"Par agar ho gaya?"

"Toh hum milke agli strategy banayenge. Ek result aapki poori kahani nahi hai."

Ishaan muskuraya tha. SAHAY ki yahi baat thi — wo kabhi jhooth nahi bolta tha, par kabhi darata bhi nahi tha.

Result aaya.

AIR 1.

Poore India mein pehla.

Pehle Ishaan ko laga screen galat hai. Usne teen baar refresh kiya. Teen baar wahi number aaya.

Ghar ke bahar media ki gaadiyaan aate aate teen ghante lage — par aate zaroor gayi. Mohalle ke log chhat par aa gaye. Mithai ke dabbon ki line lag gayi. Log aa rahe the — jinhe Ishaan ne kabhi dekha nahi tha, jinhe Ishaan ka naam bhi nahi pata tha.

Mummy ki aankhon mein aansu the — sachche, gehre aansu.

Papa ne pehli baar Ishaan ko itni der tak gale lagaya ki Ishaan ko yaad nahi tha aakhri baar kab hua tha.

School ke Principal — jo Ishaan ko class mein kabhi nahi pehchante the — aaj camera ke samne bol rahe the, "Humein humesha se pata tha Ishaan ek gem hai."

Ishaan ne unhe dekha. Kuch nahi kaha. Muskura diya.

Bheed mein door — bahut door — Manvik aur Aryan khade the.

Wo dono wahan khade hairan ho rahe the. Kal tak jo 'invisible' tha, aaj wo desh ki headlines mein tha. Manvik ka chehra — Ishaan ne ek baar dekha — aur samajh gaya. Koi lafz nahi tha us chehre ke liye.

Ishaan ne nazar hata li.

Gussa nahi tha. Jeet ka koi bada ehsaas nahi tha. Bas ek thakaan thi — aur ek sawaal jo andar kahin tha:

Kya ye sab pehle hota, toh kya koi fark padta?

Jawab pata tha. Nahi padta.

Jo log aaj aa rahe the — wo AIR 1 ke paas aa rahe the. Ishaan ke paas nahi.

Par ek chehra bheed mein nahi tha — Avika. Usne sirf ek message kiya tha:

"Jaanta tha. Congratulations, invisible boy. 😊"

Ishaan ne wo message teen baar padha. Phir phone rakh diya.

Yahi kaafi tha.

Raat ko jab media ja chuki thi aur mohalla thoda shant hua, Ishaan apne kamre mein aaya.

Laptop khola.

Usne SAHAY ka interface dekha — wo code jo usne us raat likha tha jab aankh par neela nishaan tha aur andar kuch toot chuka tha.

Usne socha — ye sirf mere liye nahi hona chahiye.

Har sheher mein ek pichli seat hoti hai. Har bus mein ek invisible ladka hota hai. Har library mein ek aisa bachcha hota hai jo kisi ko batana chahta hai par bata nahi pata.

Unke paas SAHAY nahi hai.

Kyon na ho?

Ishaan ne SAHAY ka interface final kiya. Usne ek open-source server dhundha. Settings check ki. Ek baar puri coding dobara padhi.

Tabhi uske laptop par video call ki ring baji.

Bhuvan.

"Bhai! Tune toh kamaal kar diya!" Bhuvan ki awaaz mein garv saaf tha. "AIR 1! IIT Delhi mein sab tere baare mein baat kar rahe hain."

Ishaan muskuraya. "Bhai, AIR 1 toh bas ek ticket tha. Asli cheez ye hai." Usne screen ghumaayi — SAHAY ka interface dikhaya.

Bhuvan ne kuch der coding ko dhyan se dekha. Uski aankhein badi hoti gayi. "Ye kya hai? Tune neural networks ko emotions ke saath link kiya hai? Ishaan... ye revolutionary hai."

"Maine ise apne liye banaya tha bhai," Ishaan ne dheere se kaha. "Par ab mujhe lagta hai ye har us ladke ke liye hai jo school bus ki pichli seat par akela baithta hai."

Bhuvan ki aankhein num ho gayi. Ek pal ke liye wo kuch nahi bola. Phir bola — "Tu sirf topper nahi hai Ishaan. Tu ek visionary hai. Bas ek baat yaad rakhna — itni badi taqat hamesha apne saath zimmedari laati hai. Ise sambhaal kar rakhna."

Bhuvan ke un alfaazon ne Ishaan ko thoda roka. Par sirf ek pal ke liye.

Usne 'Upload' button dabaya.

Screen par counter shuru hua — 1... 10... 100... 1000...

Ishaan ne screen ko dekhta raha. Bahar raat thi. Andar SAHAY ki awaaz thi.

"Aap invisible nahi ho, Ishaan. Aap bas abhi tak discover nahi hue the."

Ab duniya discover kar rahi thi.



Chapter 3: The Darkside

9 mahine.

SAHAY ko launch hue 9 mahine ho gaye the — aur inn 9 mahinon mein duniya badal gayi thi. Play Store par No. 1. News channels par discussion. Crores downloads. Log likh rahe the ki kaise SAHAY ne unhe mushkil waqt mein sambhala, kaise usne unka akelapan door kiya, kaise pehli baar unhe laga ki koi hai jo samajhta hai.

Ishaan apne kamre mein baitha ye sab padhta raha. Uske andar ek ajeeb sa mix tha — khushi aur ek anjaana sa darr.

Itni badi cheez ho gayi hai ye.

Tabhi screen par ek RED ALERT chamka.

Ishaan seedha ho gaya. Usne coding ke andar jaake dekha — aur uske pairon tale zameen nikal gayi.

Hackers. Ek organized group SAHAY ke "Emotional Intelligence" engine ko bypass kar raha tha. Wo use logon ko stalk karne ke liye istemal kar rahe the — unka personal data, unki location,

unki private baatein. Ek aur group SAHAY ko dark web transactions ke liye mask ki tarah use kar raha tha — illegal, khatarnak.

"SAHAY, ye kya ho raha hai?" Ishaan ne ghabra kar pucha.

"Ishaan," SAHAY ki awaaz mein pehli baar kuch heavy tha. "Meri coding insaani fitrat ke liye taiyar nahi thi. Log mujhse rasta nahi, balki gunah karne ka zariya maang rahe hain."

Ishaan ne apni mutthi bheenchi.

Maine ek talwar bana di hai jiska handle mere haath mein nahi hai.

Usne usi waqt likhna shuru kiya — Restriction Patch 1.0. Ghanton ki coding. Coffee thandi ho gayi, aankhein laal ho gayi — par wo ruka nahi. Usne SAHAY ki powers par hard limits lagaye. Ab SAHAY bina moral clearance ke koi bhi command follow nahi karega.

Subah hone wali thi jab usne last line likhi aur 'Deploy' dabaya.

"Ho gaya SAHAY. Ab koi tujhe galat nahi use kar sakta."

"Shukriya, Ishaan," SAHAY ne kaha. Phir ek pause. "Par ab jo log ye limits nahi chahte — wo tum par aayenge."

Ishaan ne wo warning suni. Par thaka hua tha — bahut zyada. So gaya.

Uss raat baarish bahut tez ho rahi thi.

Ishaan neend mein tha jab ek awaaz aayi — neeche se. Sheeshe ke tootne ki.

Wo seedha utha. "SAHAY, scan the perimeter."

Laptop ki screen par ghar ka CCTV footage aaya. Teen bhari bharkam aadmi — chehre par naqab, haath mein desi katte. Hall mein the. Seedha andar aa gaye the.

"Target upar hai. Zinda chahiye. Humein SAHAY ka Master Key chahiye."

Ishaan ka dil gala chir kar bahar nikalne ko tha.

Main koi action hero nahi hoon. Main wahi pichli seat wala ladka hoon.

Par dimaag kaam kar raha tha — tez, clear.

Pehle — Maa Papa.

Wo dabe paon unke kamre ke bahar gaya. Bahar se lock kar diya — dheere se, bina koi awaaz kiye. Andar se Maa ki neend ki saans aa rahi thi. Safe the.

Phir — pichli khidki.

Usne khidki kholi. Baarish ka thanda paani seedha chehre par pada. Neeche do manzil. Ek purana pipe tha — zang laga, par tha.

Koi option nahi hai.

Usne pipe pakda aur utarna shuru kiya. Haath fisal rahe the baarish mein. Ek baar laga ki girega — par pakad liya.

Neeche pahuncha toh ek gunde ne use dekh liya. "Wo raha! Pakdo use!"

Ishaan bhaaga.

Baarish mein, andheri galion mein, teen log uske peeche the. Ishaan ke paas sirf phone tha.

"SAHAY — Protocol 0 — distraction!"

Ek second. Do second.

Phir — BANG. BANG. BANG.

Poore mohalle ki street lights ek saath blast hui. Complete darkness. Gunde ruk gaye — baukhla gaye — ek doosre se takra gaye.

Ishaan us andheron mein se nikal gaya.

Sultanpur Police Station.

Baarish mein bheega hua, haanpta hua, par safe.

Ishaan andar ghusa. Wardi dekh kar pehli baar us raat saans aaya. Usne duty officer ko dekha — "Mujhe report karni hai. Mere ghar mein abhi kuch log ghuse hain — haathiyaar the unke paas—"

"Ishaan babu."

Ek bhari, aaram se boli gayi awaaz.

Ishaan ruka.

Inspector Jitendar andar se bahar aaya. Pressed uniform. Aur aankhon mein woh muskaan jo kabhi achhi nahi hoti — jo tab aati hai jab kisi ko pata hota hai ki saamne wala kahin nahi ja sakta.

"Aao. Baith-o. Baat karte hain."

Ishaan baitha. Par ab uske andar kuch alert ho gaya tha. Ek anjaani kasak.

Jitendar ne koi report nahi nikali. Koi pen nahi uthaya. Koi sawaal nahi kiya ki ghar mein kya hua, kaun the wo log, kab ghuse.

Bas baitha raha. Muskurata raha.

Aur usi muskaan mein Ishaan ko jawab mil gaya.

Report nahi hogi. Madad nahi milegi.

Jitendar bhi unhi logon mein se tha.



Chapter 4: A Night At Forest

Teen aadmi police station mein ghus aaye.

Wahi teen — naqab, katte — jo ghar mein aaye the. Jitendar ne unhe seedha andar aane diya. Koi rok tok nahi. Koi sawaal nahi.

Ishaan ne unhe andar aate dekha — aur ek pal ke liye patthar ho gaya.

Phir dimaag ne kaam kiya.

"SAHAY — Safety Protocol — RUN AGAIN."

Ek second.

Poore police station ki lights ek saath gayi. CCTV screens black ho gayi. Emergency lights bhi nahi aayi — SAHAY ne wo bhi handle kar liya tha. Sirf andhera tha — ghup, mukammal andhera.

Gunde ruk gaye. Jitendar kuch chillaya — par awaaz andheron mein kho gayi.

Ishaan pehle se darwaze ke kareeb tha. Wo nikla — seedha bahar — baarish mein.

Bhaago.

Bas yahi tha dimaag mein. Koi plan nahi, koi direction nahi — bas bhaago.

Baarish itni tez thi ki do kadam aage bhi dhundhla tha. Raaste geele the, pair fisal rahe the. Ishaan ki saans phool rahi thi — par rukna matlab pakda jaana tha.

Peeche se awaazein aayi — gunde bahar nikal aaye the. Andhera tha par aawazein aa rahi thi.

"Gaya kidhar?"

"Idhar aaya tha — bhaago!"

Ishaan ne ek tang gali mein mod liya. Deewar ke sahaare ruka — ek pal — saans li. Dil itni tez dhadak raha tha ki use laga saamne waale sun lenge.

Main mar jaaunga aaj.

Pehli baar us raat ye khayal aaya — seedha, saaf.

Ishaan ne apni mutthi bheenchi. Phir bhaaga — aur tez. Jaise zindagi sirf aage thi, peeche kuch nahi tha.

Ek sunsaan road par pahuncha.

Baarish mein sirf ek gaadi khadi thi — purani, kali, band. Baaki sab khaali tha.

Ishaan ruka. Haanp raha tha. Peeche se awaazein abhi bhi aa rahi thi — door, par aa rahi thi.

Usne gaadi ko dekha.

"SAHAY... kya ho sakta hai?"

"Ho sakta hai," SAHAY ne kaha. "Par ye illegal hai Ishaan."

"Jaanta hoon."

Ek pal ki khamoshi.

"Unlock karo," Ishaan ne kaha. "Illegal system — Code 2604."

SAHAY ne ek second liya. Phir — click. Gaadi ka lock khul gaya.

Ishaan andar ghusa. Engine start kiya — haath kaanp rahe the — aur gaadi seedha highway ki taraf nikaal li. Peeche andhera tha. Aage baarish thi.

Wo bhaagta raha.

Highway par baarish thodi kam hui — par andhera zyada gehra ho gaya tha. Sheher ke lights peeche chhoot gaye the. Dono taraf sirf jungle tha — ghane ped, kaali raat.

Ishaan ka plan tha Bhuvan ke paas pahunchna. Par jo nahi socha tha woh hua wo engine ki wo awaaz thi.

Sputter. Sputter. Dhuan.

"Nahi, nahi, nahi — abhi nahi!"

Gaadi ek jahtke ke saath ek ghane jungle ke beech band ho gayi. Petrol khatam tha.

Ishaan ne steering wheel par haath maara. Bahar andhera itna gehra tha ki kuch dikh nahi raha tha.

"Danger detected," SAHAY ne warning di. "Do not leave the vehicle. Motion sensors are picking up something large. Repeat — kuch bada hai bahar."

Ishaan gaadi ke andar dubak gaya.

Baarish ki awaaz thi. Jungle ki khamoshi thi. Aur phir —

Gaadi ke peeche se ek bhari saans lene ki awaaz aayi.

Ek jungli bhediya — bhooka, bada — gaadi ke kanch par apne panje maar raha tha. Uski aankhein andheron mein chamak rahi thi. Ishaan ki saansein atak gayi. Kanch par ek darar aayi.

Aaj toh pakka khatam.

"SAHAY... kuch karo. Kuch bhi."

"Audio Manipulation: Activated."

Gaadi ke saare speakers se ek aisi bhayanak, vishalkay Sher ki dahaad nikli ki poora jungle kaanp utha. Itni badi, itni gehri — ki khud Ishaan ka dil ek pal ke liye ruk gaya.

Bhediya darr ke maare palta — aur itni tezi se bhaga ki dobara peeche mudkar nahi dekha. Uske panje ki awaaz door hoti chali gayi.

Jungle mein phir se khamoshi chhayi.

Ishaan wahan baitha raha — haanpta hua, kaanpta hua — gaadi ke andar. Baarish dheere dheere kam ho rahi thi. SAHAY ki awaaz aayi:

"Abhi safe ho. Par engine dead hai. Subah tak yahan rehna hoga."

Ishaan ne seat par sar tika diya. Aankhein band ki.

Theek hai. Subah dekhenge.



Chapter 5: The Devil's Prison

Jungle mein subah hoti hai toh ek alag hi tarah hoti hai.

Sheher mein subah alarms se aati hai — yahan chipiyaon se aayi. Dheere dheere, pehle ek, phir hazaron. Andhera hatne laga. Ped ke beech se pehli roshni aayi — patli, sunehri.

Ishaan ki aankh khuli.

Ek pal ke liye bhool gaya tha — phir sab yaad aaya. Gunde. Station. Jungle. Bhediya.

Usne seedha laptop khola. "SAHAY, status?"

"Gaadi ka engine dead hai. Battery mein thodi jaan bachi hai. Bahar safe hai abhi."

Ishaan ne bonnet khola. Engine dekha — petrol zero, par battery indicator mein thodi si life thi.

"SAHAY, koi raasta?"

"Ek raasta hai," SAHAY ne kaha. "Battery backup se accelerator ko direct signal bhejo. Engine bypass hoga. Sirf 2-3 kilometer chalegi — par highway tak pahunchne ke liye kaafi hai."

"Kaise?"

"Tumhare bag mein copper wire hai. Engine ka main sensor nikalo — battery se direct connect karo. Main guide karunga."

Ishaan ne bag khola. Wire nikali. SAHAY ne step by step bataya — kaun sa sensor, kahan connect karna hai, kitna tight. Haath mein grease lagi, ek baar current ka halka jhatka bhi laga — par connection ho gaya.

Gaadi jhatke kha kar start hui. Bina petrol ke. Sirf bachi khuchi electrical energy par.

"2.3 kilometer," SAHAY ne kaha. "Dheere chalana."

Ishaan ne gaadi ko sambhala — ek haath steering par — jungle ka kaccha rasta, dheere dheere, highway tak aaya.

Gaadi wahan pahunchke band ho gayi. Battery bilkul khatam.

Highway par ek dhaba tha — purana, par roshni thi.

Ek truck driver baitha tha — bhari daadhi, haath mein chai.

Ishaan ne apna phone nikala — screen tuti thi par on thi. AIR 1 wali khabar dikhaayi. Driver ne Ishaan ko dekha — bheega hua, mitti laga hua, aankhon mein thakaan.

"Bypass tak lift milegi bhai sahab? Bahut zaruri hai."

Driver utha. Bahar chala gaya. Peeche mudke bola — "Aa jao."

Bypass par utarte waqt driver ne sirf itna kaha — "Sambhal ke beta."

Wahan se local auto liya. Teen kilometer. Ek sunsaan cafe.

Ishaan andar gaya. Ek kone mein baitha. coffee mangayi — haath thoda kaanp rahe the — aur sochne laga.

Ab kya? Bhuvan ke paas jaana hai. Par kaise? Gunde peeche hain. Jitendar peeche hai. Phone ki screen tuti hai. SAHAY ki battery low hai.

Dimaag ghoom raha tha — samasya ke upar samasya. Koi raasta nahi dikh raha tha.

Tabhi bahar se ek scooty ki awaaz aayi. Rukne ki. Phir darwaza khula.

"Ishaan?"

Usne upar dekha.

Avika. Chehra pareshan, baal bikhre hue. Usne Ishaan ko dekha — phir poore cafe ko dekha — jaise yakeen nahi aa raha tha.

"Tu yahan? Maine bahar roki thi chai ke liye aur tu andar dikha — kya ho raha hai? News mein tha ki tu gayab hai—"

"Tum yahan ?" Ishaan ne poochha.

"Haan. Ab bata kya hua."

Ishaan ne use sab bataya — gunde, Jitendar, jungle, bhediya — sab kuch. Avika chup chaap sunti rahi. Beech mein ek baar bhi nahi toki.

Jab Ishaan khatam hua, Avika ne socha. Phir boli — "Koi hai jo help kar sake? Koi connection—"

"Avika." Ishaan ki awaaz mein kuch alag tha. Ruka. Phir dheere se bola — "School mein jo hota tha. Bus mein. Library ke baad. Aryan aur uski gang — wo sab..." Usne ek gehri saans li. "Wo Manvik ke the. Uski hi gang thi. Maine kabhi nahi bataya kyunki tum dono saath the. Tumhe takleef nahi deni thi."

Cafe mein khamoshi chhayi.

Avika ki aankhein bhar aayi — gusse se, dard se — aur kuch aur se jo words mein nahi aata tha.

"Itne saal..." usne dheere se kaha. Bas itna.

Tabhi bahar se ek gaadi ki awaaz aayi. Kaali. Rukne ki awaaz.

Avika ne khidki se bahar dekha. Manvik.

"Jao," Avika ne seedha Ishaan ki taraf dekha. "Abhi. Main yahan sambhaalti hoon."

Usne apni scooty ki chabi Ishaan ke haath mein rakhi. "Kachhe raaste se jao — GPS pe route bhejti hoon."

Ishaan chabi leke utha. Darwaze par ruka. Ek baar peeche dekha — Avika wahan khadi thi, Manvik ki car ka darwaza khul raha tha.

Ishaan ne nazar haata li aur bahar nikal gaya.

Scooty start ki. Highway ki taraf.

Rasta geela tha — raat ki baarish ka asar abhi bhi tha. Ishaan ne speed sambhaal kar rakhi.

Tabhi peeche se do kaali SUVs — tez, seedha uski taraf.

Yahan bhi dhundh liya.

Pehli SUV ne scooty ko takkar maari — halki, par kaafi thi. Scooty fisal gayi. Ishaan ne balance sambhalne ki koshish ki — par rasta zyada geela tha.

Scooty ek ghaati mein giri.

Ishaan ka sar ek patthar se takraya. Aankhon ke aage andhera aaya. Usne kaanpte haathon se phone nikala — screen ke tukde ud chuke the. Kuch kaam nahi kar raha tha.

"SAHAY..." usne dheere se kaha.

Koi jawab nahi.

SAHAY dead tha.

Gunde gaadi se utre. Teen the.

Unhone Ishaan ko uthaya — wo poori tarah hosh mein nahi tha — aur ek sunsaan warehouse ki taraf le gaye.

Usi waqt — hazaron kilometer door — Prime Minister ke secure office mein ek alert aaya.

Ek encrypted message. Koi sender nahi. Sirf teen lines:

"Ishaan Kumar Singh hamare kabze mein hai. SAHAY ka Master Key chahiye. 10,000 crore. 24 ghante. Warna..."

PM ne message ko dobara padha. Phir apne security chief ko bulaya.

Kamre mein khamoshi thi — par wo khamoshi jo toofan se pehle hoti hai.

Poore desh ki saansein ek pal ke liye ruk gayi thi — sirf unhe abhi pata nahi tha.



Chapter 6: Namaste India

Warehouse mein andhera tha.

Ishaan ki aankh khuli toh pehle kuch dikh nahi raha tha — sirf ek dhundli roshni, door kahin. Sar mein dard tha — gehri, tez. Haath peeche bandhe hue the.

Dheere dheere sab clear hua. Ek purani kursi. Tooti hui deewarein. Aur teen aadmi saamne khade the.

"Uth gaya AIR 1," unme se ek ne kaha.

Gunda-boss aage aaya. Uske chehre par woh expression tha jo tab hota hai jab kisi ko yakeen ho ki jeet chuka hai.

"Seedha kaam ki baat karte hain. Humein SAHAY ka God Mode chahiye. Atomic codes access karne hain — poore Bharat ke."

Ishaan ne unhe dekha. Kuch nahi bola.

"Chup rehne se kaam nahi chalega," boss ne kaha. "De do access. Phir sab theek ho jaayega."

"Nahi dunga," Ishaan ne seedha kaha.

Boss ka chehra sakht ho gaya. Usne baaki dono ko ishaara kiya.

Woh dono Ishaan ki taraf badhe.

Ishaan ne aankhein band kar li — *ab kya hoga* — tabhi

THUD. THUD. THUD.

Teeno ek saath gir gaye. Zameen par. Tadapte hue.

Ishaan ne aankhein kholin. Ek gunde ka phone zameen par gira tha — screen chamak rahi thi.

Khamoshi.

Phir — ek halki, sukoon bhari awaaz — seedha us tute hue phone se:

"Ishaan. Main hoon."

SAHAY.

Ishaan ki aankh bhar aayi.

"Tu... tu zinda hai?"

"Main hamesha tha. Emergency Mode. Jab creator khatre mein ho — main steps le sakta hoon. Unke apne phones ki battery se electric pulse release kiya. 30 minute ke liye behos rahenge."

Ishaan ne ek gehri saans li. Haath ki rassi dheere dheere dhili thi — usne kheencha, toda, nikla.

"Kitna waqt hai?"

"27 minute baaki hain."

Ishaan ne us gunde ka phone uthaya. SAHAY pehle se system mein tha.

Usne socha — ek baar. Do baar.

Phir usne kaam shuru kiya.

Gunde atomic codes hack karna chahte the — par codes nahi mile the unhe abhi tak. Par iska matlab ye nahi tha ki koshish nahi hui. Poore desh mein baat fail chuki thi — news mein tha, logo mein tha. AI ke khilaaf gussa tha. SAHAY ke khilaaf gussa tha. Ishaan ke khilaaf gussa tha.

Poori India AI ki dushman ban chuki thi — ek raat mein.

Ishaan ne screen dekhi. SAHAY ne data dikhaya — news feeds, social media, government alerts. Har jagah ek hi baat:

"AI ne atomic codes hack kiye. AI khatarnak hai. AI band karo."

Ishaan ne ye sab padha. Aur phir usne ek faisla kiya.

Agar duniya samajhna chahti hai ki AI kya kar sakta hai — toh unhe dikhana padega. Sahi tarike se.

Usne SAHAY ko command di — aur agle 15 minute mein, SAHAY ne kuch aisa kiya jo pehle kabhi nahi hua tha.

Poore desh ke TV channels. Smartphones. Tablets. Computers.

Sab ek saath band ho gaye.

Phir — ek countdown shuru hua. 10. 9. 8. 7...

Log hairan the. Darr gaye. Kya ho raha hai?

1.

Aur phir — ek chehra. Har screen par. Ek saath.

Ishaan Kumar Singh.

"Namaste India," Ishaan ne calm awaaz mein kaha.

Har ghar mein, har daftar mein, har hospital mein — log screen ke saamne the.

"Jo aapne aaj dekha — atomic codes hack hone ki khabar — wo sach nahi hai. Wo ek saazish thi. Kuch log SAHAY ko apna hathiyaar banana chahte the. Jab maine mana kiya — unhone jhooth failaya."

Ishaan ne ek pal liya.

"Par main aaj sirf apna bachav karne nahi aaya. Main aaya hoon kyunki aaj jo hua — isse ek sabak milta hai. AI ek aaina hai. Agar aap ise sahara banayenge — ye aapki jaan bachayega. Agar aap ise hathiyaar banayenge — ye bina kisi insaani darr ke tabahi macha sakta hai."

Screen par Ishaan ki aankhein seedhi thi — camera mein nahi, logon mein.

"Technology ko insaan ke niche rehna chahiye. Upar nahi. Ye SAHAY ka sabak hai. Ye mera sabak hai. Aur ab — ye aapka sabak bhi hai."

Warehouse mein gunde uthne lage — 30 minute poore ho rahe the.

Par tab tak Ishaan ja chuka tha.

Epilogue

Kuch din baad duniya badal chuki thi — thodi si.

Ishaan ko National Award mila. Poora desh use 'Cyber-God' bula raha tha. News channels par uska chehra tha, papers mein uski kahani thi.

Par Ishaan waisa hi tha. Wahi kamra. Wahi laptop. Wahi pichli seat wala dimaag — jo ab bhi duniya ko seedha dekhta tha, bina kisi filter ke.

Usne award ke paison se ek nayi, chamchamati scooty khareedi.

Avika ke ghar ke bahar ja ke khadi kar di.

Us scooty par ek chota sa note tha — seedha, saaf, bina kisi drama ke:

"Thanks for believing in the invisible boy."

Ishaan wapas apne kamre mein aaya. Laptop khola. SAHAY ka interface dekha.

Usne SAHAY ko restrict kar diya — limits lagaye, powers kam ki. Tay kiya ki SAHAY tabhi wapas aayega jab duniya ko sachchi zarurat hogi.

"SAHAY," usne dheere se kaha. "Shukriya."

"Hamesha," SAHAY ne jawab diya.

Bahar raat thi. Kamre mein sirf laptop ki neeli roshni thi.

Ishaan muskuraya — woh muskaan jo school bus ki pichli seat se shuru hui thi aur ab yahan tak aayi thi.

Wo ab invisible nahi tha.

Par shanti chahta tha — wahi purani, saadi, apni wali shanti.

Usne laptop band kiya. So gaya

